

ON THE OFFENSIVE
Mamata at an election rally in Laudoha village under Pandabeswar assembly seat, Mar. 26

THE INCUMBENT

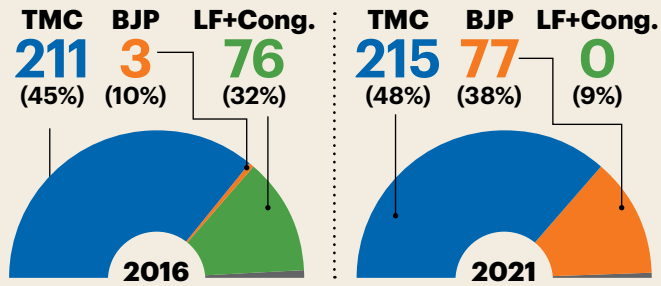
Mamata Banerjee , 71, TMC
Chief Minister, West Bengal

KEY STRATEGIES

- Has fused *'Bangaliyana'* with her political identity, projecting herself, her party and Bengali cultural pride as a single continuum. Calls the BJP anti-Bengali
- Has aggressively politicised the Election Commission's SIR and described voter deletions as institutional bias. Presented her government's case herself in the Supreme Court
- Her campaign rests on a welfare architecture, with schemes like Lakshmir Bhandar and Krishak Bandhu projected as evidence of governance delivery
- Women form the core of her poll strategy, with direct benefit transfers and symbolic outreach. This consolidates what has been one of the most stable voter blocs in her favour across rural Bengal
- Emphasises continuity over fresh promises by presenting her manifesto as an extension of existing schemes and governance

PAST RECORD

Total seats: **294**



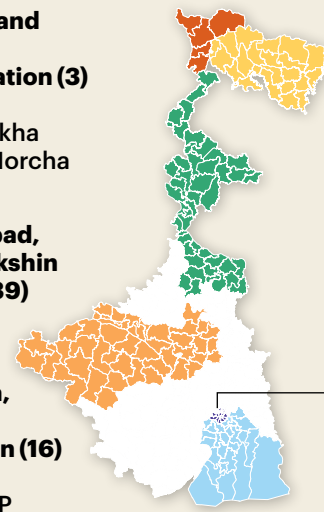
Numbers denote seats won; vote share in (); LF: Left Front

THE BATTLE ZONES

Gorkhaland Territorial Administration (3)
*Gorkha
#BJP & Gorkha Janmukti Morcha

Malda, Murshidabad, Uttar & Dakshin Dinajpur (39)
*Muslim
#TMC

Bankura, Purulia, Bardhaman (16)
*Bagdi
#TMC & BJP



North Bengal (25)
*Rajbanshi & tea workers, mostly STs
#BJP & TMC

Nadia, North and South 24 Parganas (21)
*Matua #TMC & BJP (2021)

Kolkata (11)
*Primarily the Bengali bhadralok
#TMC

**Swing social groups; no. of seats in ()*
#Dominant party in the past two assembly polls